

FAISAL AHAMED SYED

Cybersecurity Graduate Student | SOC Analyst | Network & Security Engineer
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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Cybersecurity graduate student with hands-on experience in SOC operations, network troubleshooting, and enterprise security infrastructure. Working knowledge of L2/L3 routing and switching, OSPF, BGP, VLANs, STP, and firewall administration through coursework and lab work. Experienced in SIEM monitoring, threat hunting, MITRE ATT&CK mapping, EDR response, and Zero Trust IAM. CompTIA Security+ certified and currently pursuing CCNA. Authorized to work in the US on OPT - no sponsorship required

EDUCATION

Master of Science in Computer Information Systems & Cybersecurity

Auburn University at Montgomery | Aug 2024 – May 2026

GPA: 3.51

Relevant Coursework: Network Security, Penetration Testing, Advance Network Systems, Cryptography, Advanced Operating Systems, Linux & Unix, Cloud & IoT Security, Back end Web Development

CERTIFICATIONS

CompTIA Security+ | Google Cybersecurity Professional Certificate | CCNA (In progress)

SECURITY OPERATIONS SKILLS

SIEM Monitoring & Alert Triage | Incident Response & Escalation | Threat Hunting & IOC Analysis | Vulnerability Scanning & Risk-Based Remediation | Log Analysis (Firewall, Email, Web) | Identity & Access Management (IAM) | Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA) | EDR Monitoring & Response | MITRE ATT&CK Framework | Zero Trust Architecture | Security Policies & Procedures | Endpoint Management & Patch Deployment (PDQ)

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Security Tools: Splunk SIEM, Corelog, Nessus, PDQ, Barracuda, Burp Suite, Spirion

QA & Automation Tools: Selenium, Playwright, Robot Framework, Browser Library, Postman, Lighthouse, BrowserStack

Networking: TCP/IP, DNS, HTTP/HTTPS, VPN, Firewalls, Wireshark

Operating Systems: Windows, Kali Linux, Ubuntu

Scripting: Python, Bash, SQL

Frameworks & Concepts: OWASP Top 10, Vulnerability Management, Incident Response, SIEM Operations, DMARC

EXPERIENCE

Security Analyst Intern

Auburn University at Montgomery | Jan 2026 – May 2026

- Monitored and triaged 20+ security alerts daily using SIEM, mapping threat behaviors to MITRE ATT&CK tactics and techniques to support real-time threat detection and SOC operations
- Conducted vulnerability assessments using Nessus across 50+ endpoints, assisting with remediation prioritization that reduced high-risk vulnerabilities by approximately 30%
- Performed threat hunting activities by analyzing firewall, email, and web security logs, identifying 10+ indicators of compromise (IOCs) per week and escalating confirmed threats per SOC procedures
- Utilized PDQ for patch deployment and endpoint management across 200+ campus devices, supporting EDR aligned secure configuration and reducing patch lag by around 40%
- Supported IAM operations including MFA enforcement and access control for 500+ enterprise users, reinforcing zero trust access policies and reducing unauthorized access attempts
- Documented 15+ incidents per month, capturing findings and remediation steps using structured workflows consistent with SOAR playbook practices

IT Services Helpdesk Assistant

Auburn University at Montgomery | Nov 2024 – Dec 2025

- Supported 100+ users weekly with Active Directory authentication and secure access issues
- Assisted with Duo MFA deployment and support for 500+ users, improving secure access adoption
- Troubleshoot wireless networks, DNS issues, and endpoint connectivity problems
- Utilized PDQ for patch deployment and endpoint management, ensuring timely updates and secure configuration across campus systems
- Resolved incidents via phone, email, Zoom, and onsite support while meeting SLA targets

QA Engineer

Buzops | Jan 2023 – May 2024

- Designed and executed automated security test suites for 5+ web applications using Selenium and Playwright, covering SQLi, XSS, and CSRF attack vectors, reducing manual testing effort by an estimated 40%
- Developed and maintained automated API test scripts using Postman across 10+ API endpoints, integrating validation into the secure SDLC pipeline to catch defects pre-deployment
- Built end-to-end regression automation frameworks using Robot Framework with Browser Library, achieving full feature and regression coverage across multiple release cycles
- Conducted cross-browser and cross-device compatibility testing using BrowserStack, ensuring consistent application behavior across 10+ browser/OS combinations
- Performed web performance and accessibility audits using Lighthouse, identifying and reporting front-end bottlenecks and accessibility violations to development teams
- Supported CI/CD pipeline testing by embedding Python-based automated scripts (Selenium/Playwright) into the software development lifecycle, improving release velocity and test repeatability
- Collaborated with development and security teams to identify and remediate 20+ application vulnerabilities per release cycle, reducing production security defects by an estimated 25%

Associate Quality Analyst

Tech Axis Group | May 2022 – Dec 2022

- Developed and executed comprehensive manual test plans and test cases using Jira, ensuring full feature and regression coverage across multiple release cycles
- Performed functional, smoke, and regression testing on web applications, identifying and logging 15+ defects per sprint with detailed reproduction steps and severity classifications
- Managed and tracked bug lifecycle end-to-end in Jira, coordinating with development teams to prioritize and resolve defects within sprint timelines
- Conducted impact analysis on new features and code changes, assessing test coverage gaps and collaborating with developers to improve overall application stability
- Participated in sprint planning and defect triage meetings, contributing test insights to improve release readiness and reduce post-deployment issues

SECURITY LABS

- TryHackMe - SOC Analyst & Blue Team Labs
- Hands-on experience with log analysis, incident response, and Linux system hardening
- Applied MITRE ATT&CK framework to map adversary techniques during simulated attack scenarios
- Practiced threat hunting and alert triage workflows using EDR tools in blue team lab environments
- Simulated SOAR playbook logic for automated alert escalation and incident containment